LEARNER GUIDE

# Rounding: which is nearest?

Place Value · Lesson 7. A short guide to walk beside you — read as much or as little as helps. *Connection before curriculum. Always.*

## What this lesson is about

To **round** a number to the nearest 10, find the two multiples of 10 it lies between (the markers) and choose the one it is **nearer** to. 347 lies between 340 and 350: it is 7 from 340 and 3 from 350, so it rounds to 350. A number exactly halfway, such as 345, could go either way, so we agree a convention: **halfway rounds up**. Rounding to the nearest 100, 1,000, whole number or 0.1 works the same way.

## What you are learning to notice

- Every rounded answer is one of the two markers either side of the number.
- The halfway point between the markers decides: below it, round down; at it or above, round up.
- The same number can round differently: 583 is 580 to the nearest 10 but 600 to the nearest 100.
- Round once, from the number itself. Rounding in steps (349 → 350 → 400) gives the wrong answer.
- The digit in the next column tells you which side of halfway the number is.

## Moving through it, one step at a time

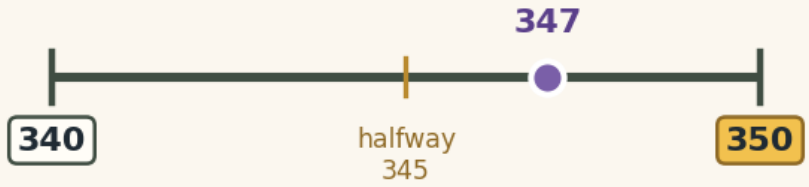
Find the two markers the number lies between. Find the halfway point between them. If the number is below halfway, round to the lower marker; if it is at halfway or above, round to the higher one. Check: is your answer one of the two markers?

## Worked examples

Two full examples to follow. Read them slowly — the aim is to see how each line follows from the one before, not to memorise a rule. It can help to cover the steps and predict the next line before you reveal it.

**Example 1 — 347 to the nearest 10**

Round 347 to the nearest 10.

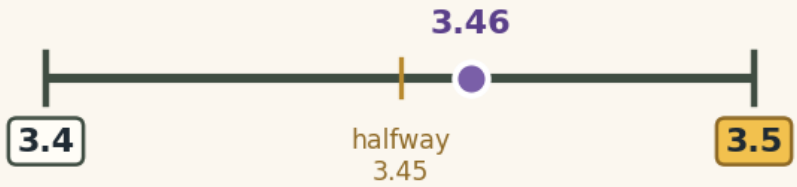



| | |
|---|---|
| **1.** 347 lies between the markers | 340 and 350 |
| **2.** Halfway between them is | 345 |
| **3.** 347 is past halfway: 3 from 350, 7 from 340. | 350 |

**347 rounded to the nearest 10 is 350.**

**Example 2 — 3.46 to the nearest 0.1**

Round 3.46 to the nearest 0.1.




| | |
|---|---|
| **1.** 3.46 lies between the markers | 3.4 and 3.5 |
| **2.** Halfway between them is | 3.45 |
| **3.** 3.46 is past halfway: 0.04 from 3.5, 0.06 from 3.4. | 3.5 |

**3.46 rounded to the nearest 0.1 is 3.5.**

**A gentle reminder**

You can pause. You can return. You do not need to complete everything in one sitting.

## If you get stuck

Getting stuck is part of doing mathematics, not a sign that something is wrong. There is support built into the lesson, and using it is a strong move:

- **Reconnection Routes** — if an earlier idea feels shaky (comparing numbers (Lesson 6)), open a short recap and return whenever you are ready.
- **Socratic prompt** — a question to nudge your thinking.
- **Hint** — a little more help with the step in front of you.
- **Check** — try an answer and see how you are doing; a wrong try is useful information.
- **Worked solution** — a full model to compare your thinking against.

**How the worked solution unlocks**

The worked solution unlocks after you use the Socratic prompt, use the hint, and check two answers. Those steps are the learning — the worked solution is there to confirm your thinking, not to replace it.

Using support is part of learning. It is not cheating.

## Recording your thinking

You can show your working in whatever way suits you today — the on-screen Scratchpad, paper, a spoken explanation, or a photo of a sketch. There is no single right format. If you do not finish everything in one sitting, that is completely fine: what you have done is information for your next step, never a failure.

## Before you begin

Settle into a comfortable pace and take the steps one at a time. If your attention drifts, pause and come back — the lesson will keep your place. When you are ready, begin.

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